

Apprenticeship Additional Knowledge Unit

Unit Introduction





Unit Introduction

The key elements of
the unit



Welcome to the Unit

Welcome to the Apprenticeship Additional Knowledge Unit.

Here we will introduce you to the key elements of the unit and provide an insight into how to get the most from your studies.

Let's start with a tour of the content covered in this unit.





The Unit Content

Over the next three lessons, we will address three critical areas at the heart of how organisations function – sustainability, organisational governance and technology.

In the first lesson, we'll explore sustainability, beginning with an introduction to related concepts and models, and sustainability's impact on organisational operations. We'll discuss the business case for sustainability, and outline the growing pressures driving companies in this area, along with best practice standards and frameworks.

Finally, we'll focus on how managers can identify opportunities to improve sustainability within their own organisations.



The Unit Content (cont.)

Lesson two looks at organisational governance, starting with best practice and compliance, as well as the implications of falling short in this area. The lesson continues with an overview of the relevant legislation and regulation informing organisational policies – focusing on GDPR, health and safety, and equality, diversity and inclusion.

In lesson three, we'll examine the role of technology, and its applications in the workplace – including software packages, problem-solving, communication, and organisational security. We will also learn about emerging technology, and the rising use of artificial intelligence in the business world.



The Importance of this Unit

Understanding how sustainability, organisational governance, and technology affect and influence organisations is a key responsibility for a senior manager.

Whether you're an experienced leader or newer to management, this unit will help you to develop mastery in these areas, and serve you well as you progress in your role.



The Structure of the Unit

Each unit is split up into lessons, which are in turn divided into four sections:

- Learn
- Test
- Apply
- Insights

The Learn section is built around short video lectures, which introduce you to the learning content covered in the unit. In some lessons, you'll also find written materials that expand on the concepts in more detail.

The Test section includes a set of self-check questions that ensure you have grasped the content of the lesson.



The Structure of the Unit (cont.)

The Apply section is made up of practical exercises, which aim to assess your knowledge in more depth. They'll build a record of your learning as you progress and can be used as evidence of the relevant knowledge criteria for your apprenticeship.

The Insights section provides carefully selected concepts, reading material and other resources to enrich your learning, and broaden your knowledge of the topics covered in each lesson. You can use this section to stretch and challenge yourself, and gain a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



Study Tips

Before you get started, here are a few tips to help you get the most out of your studies.

Set aside enough time to complete your tasks every week. You'll find it helpful to keep track of the unit calendar, so you don't fall behind.

We recommend that you attempt all the questions and activities in each of the sections. We provide 'correct' and 'incorrect' feedback and model answers to support your understanding.

Physically write notes when studying either online or in the classroom. Research consistently shows that even just the process of writing detailed notes helps greatly with learning. We have provided you with a Study Notepad and pen in your Welcome Pack.

Once again, welcome to the Apprenticeship Additional Knowledge Unit. We hope you enjoy your studies.



Recap

In this unit introduction, you have learned about:

- The key elements of the unit